



Light Tank Mark VIB

The Light Tank Mark VI was part of a series developed by Vickers-Armstrongs for the British Army. It was ordered in large numbers from 1936 since it was considered well suited to policing the empire and performing reconnaissance—as well as being relatively cheap. When war broke out in September 1939, over 1,000 of these light tanks were in British Army service, compared to just 150 heavier tanks.

USED FOR SCOUTING and securing the flanks of armored forces, the Light Tank Mark VIB was a fast tank for its time, reaching up to 35 mph/(56 km/h) on its Horstmann suspension. Armed with a double machine-gun housing, the turret had two Vickers machine guns—a .50 and a .303. The tank's armor was just over .511 in (13 mm) at its thickest—enough to stop bullets, but nothing heavier.

The three crewmen consisted of the driver, who sat at the front to the left of the engine, and the gunner and commander, who sat in the turret. The commander also acted as the radio operator. Due to its minimal length, the tank could pitch and rock when traveling over rough ground, forcing the gunner and commander in the turret to hang on to avoid being thrown around. The VIB equipped seven cavalry regiments of the British Army's newly formed Royal Armoured Corps in 1940, alongside VIB vehicles in a number of the Royal Tank Regiments. It saw action in many of the early campaigns of World War II, including France and Libya in 1940, and Greece and Crete in 1941.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	Light Tank Mark VIB
Date	1936
Origin	UK
Production	1,682
Engine	Meadows 6-cylinder gasoline, 88 hp
Weight	5 tons (4.85 tonnes)
Main armament	.50-cal Vickers
Secondary armament	.30-cal Vickers
Crew	3
Armor thickness	.511 in (13 mm)

Commander

Gunner

Driver

Engine